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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

## Broadway upzoning plan divides Edgewater

Change would upend usual procedures, allow developers to build more

By Jake Sheridan  
Chicago Tribune

In the empty sky above a grocery store parking lot, Ald. Leni Manaa-Hoppenworth can see the future.

There are more trees, more people walking. Gone is the gray asphalt that sits before her on Edgewater's 6000 block of North Broadway. She imagines a tall building rising in its place, bustling with commercial space at the bottom.

That building in her mind's eye is one of many that could sprout up along a 2.6-mile stretch of the North Side thoroughfare from West Montrose Avenue to West Devon Avenue. That's where she hopes to implement a sweeping "upzoning" plan that would make it easier for developers to build more.

It's a change she thinks will make Edgewater better connected, less expensive to rent an apartment in and more full of life, a model for how Mayor Brandon Johnson wants to spur affordable housing across Chicago. But it's furiously opposed by a group of activists who say it will destroy small businesses and all but ruin the neighborhood's character, a familiar argument when zoning fights have played out elsewhere.

"That could be housing on top, with parking underneath,"

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EILEEN T. MESLAR/TRIBUNE

## Bears practice fields soon to come alive

The synergy between Ben Johnson and Caleb Williams is the top storyline to watch as Bears training camp opens. **Chicago Sports**

## Trump chisels at Congress' power

The Republican-controlled Congress has shown a willingness to cede more of its prerogatives to the presidency. **Nation & World**

## Demand growing at area food pantries

As large cuts to SNAP loom, the task of feeding hungry Illinoisans falls more than ever to nonprofits. **Chicagoland, Page 2**



Pastor Julie Contreras hugs Xally Morales, 13, on July 2 as she and her family leave United Giving Hope Sanctuary in Waukegan. Xally's family received letters from the Department of Homeland Security informing them that their humanitarian parole has been revoked and they must leave the country immediately. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

# Letters tell children to leave the country

Chicago-area kids get deportation notices saying 'the federal government will find you'

By Laura Rodríguez Presa  
Chicago Tribune

Thirteen-year-old Xally Morales stared blankly at a letter she received from the Department of Homeland Security last month. She could not read the dozens of lines in English addressed to her.

She arrived in the country from Mexico a little over seven months ago, crossing the southern border in search of safety. Xally knows very little English.

"They say I have to leave the country immediately," the young teen whispered in Spanish, barely meeting anyone's eyes at a Chicago law firm on a recent Friday afternoon.

No explanation. No hearing. And no time. The night she received the letter, she said, the family went into hiding after her older sister translated the letter for her.

"Trump wants me to go back to Mexico. But how can I do that alone?" Xally told the Tribune.

"I'm scared ICE will come for me."

Xally is one of at least 12 children in the Waukegan area — all unaccompanied minors from Mexico — who received sudden deportation letters from DHS last month, according to advocates. All of the girls legally entered the country within the past year under humanitarian parole as unaccompanied minors and were later reunited with undocumented parents or other family already living in the U.S.

But despite that reunification, the girls are unable to be legally represented by their parents in immigration court due to the way they entered the country.

Immigration advocates warn that these cases are becoming more common, with a growing number of children now receiving letters from DHS ending their humanitarian parole. They say this could signal a troubling shift under the Trump administration.

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Philip Odango, left, and David Charles attend an LGBTQ outreach Mass at Our Lady of Mount Carmel Church in Chicago on July 13. The Mass was organized by the Catholic Archdiocese of Chicago's LGBTQ+ outreach ministry, AGLO Chicago. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

## Will Pope Leo XIV forge greater LGBTQ+ inclusion?

Chicago-area Catholics pray for 'reconciliation rather than division'

By Angie Leventis Lourgos  
Chicago Tribune

With a mix of curiosity and a little apprehension, the man stepped inside Our Lady of Mount Carmel in East Lakeview to celebrate Mass on a recent Sunday.

It was the first time David Charles of Des Plaines had entered a church in roughly 20

years. During college he felt called to ministry, until his on-campus Methodist pastor in another state discovered he'd been secretly dating a man.

"In no unclear terms he said, 'You either stop this now or this is where our road ends,'" Charles recalled. "So I said, 'This is where our road ends.' And that was that. It was devastating ... like a path was taken from me."

Ever since, Charles felt like a nomad without a spiritual home,

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TODAY'S WEATHER



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Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 20

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